

Using the Ruby Text Tag to Mark Up Foreign Language

The **<ruby>** text tag in HTML is used to provide annotations or pronunciations for words — most commonly in East Asian languages like Chinese or Japanese, where characters may need pronunciation (called *furigana* in Japanese or *pinyin* in Chinese). However, it can also be used to mark up and explain foreign or uncommon words in any language by adding a small note above (or beside) the text.

Basic Structure

```
<ruby>
  ■ <rt>hàn</rt>
  ■ <rt>zì</rt>
</ruby>
```

<ruby> — the container element for the base text and its annotation.

<rt> — stands for “ruby text”; it defines the pronunciation or meaning.

<rp> (optional) — stands for “ruby parenthesis”; it provides fallback text for browsers that don’t support ruby annotations.

Example: Annotating a Foreign Word

```
<p>
  The word <ruby>bonjour<rt>hello</rt></ruby> means "hello" in French.
</p>
```

With Fallback for Unsupported Browsers

```
<p>
  The Japanese greeting
  <ruby>■■■■■<rp>(<rt>konnichiwa</rt><rp>)</rp></ruby> means "hello".
</p>
```

Use Cases:

- To provide pronunciation guides for foreign words.
- To offer translations or definitions inline.
- To annotate technical terms or abbreviations with short notes.

Summary

Tag	Purpose
<ruby>	Wraps the main text and its annotation
<rt>	Provides the annotation (pronunciation or translation)
<rp>	Optional fallback parentheses for older browsers